The Paper Lantern Library

Read. Study. Draw. - Hamra, Beirut

Fictional business profile created for EECE 503P/798S: Agentic Systems

1. About Us

The Paper Lantern Library is a small community library on the second floor of 14 Makdessi Street in Hamra, Beirut. It was founded in 2019 by librarian Rania Haddad, who wanted a neighborhood space where people could borrow books, study in peace, and discover their creative side. Today the library holds around 8,000 books in Arabic, English and French, and runs a regular drawing program for teens, adults and children.

2. Mission

To make reading and creativity accessible to everyone by combining a lending library, a quiet study space and an art studio under one roof, at prices students and families can afford.

3. Opening Hours

- **Monday to Saturday:** 9:00 AM - 7:00 PM
- **Closed:** Sundays and public holidays
- **Winter break:** closed December 20 - January 4

4. Memberships

Plan	Price	Details
Student	$5 / month	Requires a valid student ID
Adult	$8 / month	One person aged 18+
Family	$15 / month	Up to 4 people living in the same household
Day pass	$2 / day	Reading room access only; no borrowing

All memberships include borrowing privileges (except the day pass), free reading room access, and member pricing on all drawing classes.

5. Library Services

- **Book lending:** members may borrow up to 4 books at a time for 3 weeks, with one renewal allowed.
- **Late returns:** $0.25 per book per day.
- **Reading room:** 30 quiet seats with Wi-Fi and backup generator power, so it stays open during electricity cuts.
- **Kids' Corner:** free story time every Saturday at 11:00 AM for children of all ages.
- **Book donations:** gently used books in good condition are welcome at the front desk.

6. Lantern Sketch Sessions (Drawing Classes)

Our signature program. Drawing classes are held **every three weeks on Saturdays**, each built around a theme, and are taught by illustrator Karim Nassar. Beginners are welcome; no experience is needed. All materials are included: sketchbook, graphite pencils, charcoal and erasers.

Class	Ages	Time	Seats	Price
Lantern Sketch Session	14+	3:00 - 5:30 PM	15	$10 members / $15 non-members
Little Sketchers	7 - 12	1:00 - 2:00 PM	10	$6 members / $8 non-members

Upcoming sessions

Date	Theme
Saturday, October 24, 2026	Urban Sketching: Beirut Balconies
Saturday, November 14, 2026	Portrait Basics
Saturday, December 5, 2026	Still Life: Light and Shadow
Saturday, January 16, 2027	Ink and Wash (after the winter break)

7. Class Policies

- **Registration:** in person at the front desk or by email. Registration closes on the Thursday before each session.
- **Payment:** cash at the front desk on or before the day of the class.
- **Cancellations:** full refund if cancelled at least 48 hours before the class; later cancellations receive a credit toward a future session.
- **Full classes:** students can join a waitlist and are contacted if a seat opens.
- **Little Sketchers:** a parent or guardian must sign the child in and pick them up.

8. Our Team

Name	Role	Background
Rania Haddad	Founder & Head Librarian	Holds a master's degree in library science and spent 12 years as a university librarian before opening Paper Lantern in 2019.
Karim Nassar	Drawing Instructor	Illustrator and art teacher with 10 years of experience; specializes in urban sketching and portraiture.
Maya Khoury	Children's Programs Coordinator	Runs Saturday story time and assists with Little Sketchers; background in early childhood education.
Joe Saliba	Memberships & Front Desk	Handles memberships, class registrations and book returns; the first face visitors meet.

9. What Makes Us Different

- A library and an art studio in one place.

- Affordable classes with every material included; no shopping list needed.
- A quiet, always-powered study space, even during electricity cuts.
- A trilingual collection in Arabic, English and French.
- Programs for every age, from Saturday story time to adult drawing classes.

10. Contact

- **Address:** 14 Makdessi Street, 2nd floor, Hamra, Beirut
- **Email:** hello@paperlanternlibrary.example
- **In person:** front desk, during opening hours